Week 8 | Friday checks

2026-12-11 | Three brief items per check. Record accuracy and support separately.

Spelling

Use three words explicitly taught from each learner's current HMH sound-spelling pattern. Say the word, use it in a sentence, repeat it. Record encoding separately from supported pattern recognition. Words: _____ _____ _____.

Grade 3 reading | A Chair for My Mother

Use the actual book, with the planned access supports.

1. What problem does the character face?

Teacher key: Identifies the selected scene's problem.

2. Show an action the character takes.

Teacher key: Identifies a character action shown in the book.

3. Use the book to explain how that action affects the outcome.

Teacher key: Connects action and outcome using a relevant scene; accept planned access.

Grade 4 reading | Action Jackson

Use the actual book, with the planned access supports.

1. What is this book mostly about?

Teacher key: Names a central idea supported by the selected pages.

2. Show an important detail.

Teacher key: Identifies a relevant fact or illustration.

3. How does that detail help explain the central idea?

Teacher key: Connects that evidence to the idea; accept planned access.

Math | Week 8

Grade 3

3.3H

1. Compare one half and one fourth.

2. Compare three fourths and one fourth.

3. Show that two fourths and one half are equal.

Teacher key

1/2 greater; 3/4 greater; equal

Grade 4

4.3A | 4.3B | 4.3E

1. Build 3/4 in two ways as a sum of same-denominator fractions; record both equations.

2. Model 3/4 - 1/4 and name the result.

3. Build 1 whole plus 1/2 from halves and record 1/2 + 1/2 + 1/2.

Teacher key

1/4 + 2/4 and 1/4 + 1/4 + 1/4; 2/4 (or 1/2); 3/2 = 1 1/2.

Science | Week 8

Experiment replaces the separate science quiz

Design-and-test lab: reuse the familiar ramp setup. Grade 3 demonstrates a motion/energy finding (3.8B). Grade 4 tests smooth and textured surfaces for a friction pattern (4.7). Make one planned change, repeat three times, and use a photo or model to explain the evidence. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

Grade 3

3.8A | 3.8B

1. Plan slow and faster runs of the same car into the same foam block; name what stays the same.
2. Run and repeat the comparison, resetting the block. Identify observed speed and block movement.
3. Use the observed effect on the block to explain how speed relates to mechanical energy.

Teacher key

Keeps car/block/surface/collision point fixed; records actual observations; faster motion of the same object has more mechanical energy, supported by the observed greater effect. Recheck setup if results are inconsistent.

Grade 4

4.7

1. Test the same car on smooth board and felt.
2. Describe a repeatable difference.
3. Identify friction as the force related to slowing.

Teacher key

Controlled surface test; plausible observed difference; friction

Additional product: Social studies

Writing: one clear idea, relevant detail/reason and understandable communication. Social studies: a correct person/event or community claim, relevant source evidence and supported connection. Score each criterion 0/1 with prompts noted; apply school grading rules.